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Firebox basket for barbecue grill or smoker

Abstract

The present disclosure is directed to a firebox basket for a barbeque grill or smoker. In one form, the present disclosure provides a grill comprising an ash depository, a firebox basket positioned in the grill above the ash depository; and a cooking rack positioned above the firebox basket. The firebox basket comprises: a support basket defining an internal area, the support basket comprising: a plurality of concentrically stacked rungs that define a side wall of the firebox basket; and a grate positioned at a bottom of the plurality of concentrically stacked rungs; and a plurality of ceramic pieces disposed within the support basket. The support basket is configured to support the plurality of ceramic pieces around the internal area of the support basket.

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Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) The present application claims priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/235,034, filed Aug. 19, 2021, the entirety of which is hereby incorporated by reference.

BACKGROUND

(1) Kamado-style grills and kettle grills are designed to hold fuel, such as charcoal and wood, in a bottom portion of the grill. Some kamado-style grills comprise a separate firebox unit composed of ceramic to hold the fuel. These firebox units are typically very heavy and can be supported by the ceramic outer shell of the kamado-style grill. The benefit of the ceramic firebox is it can retain heat from the burning fuel within the firebox.

(2) Kettle-style grills, on the other hand, may hold fuel directly in the bottom portion without a separate firebox unit. Kettle-style grills are typically composed of metal and a kamado-style ceramic firebox may be too heavy to be placed directly within a metal kettle-style grill.

(3) Over time, firebox units may break due to being constantly subjected to high temperatures. Thus, it may become necessary to replace the firebox unit. Current designs for firebox units are cumbersome and hard to replace.

(4) Thus, there is a need for a less cumbersome firebox design that maintains the benefits of ceramic fireboxes while addressing the issues of their weight and replaceability.

SUMMARY OF THE DISCLOSURE

(5) The present disclosure addresses the above problems and provides a firebox basket for a barbecue grill or smoker.

(6) In one form, the present disclosure provides a firebox basket configured to use with a grill. The firebox basket comprises: a support basket defining an internal area and a plurality of ceramic pieces disposed within the support basket, wherein the support basket is configured to support the plurality of ceramic pieces around the internal area of the support basket.

(7) In some implementations, at least one ceramic piece of the plurality of ceramic pieces is configured to be removable from the firebox basket.

(8) In another form, the present disclosure provides a grill comprising an ash depository; a firebox basket positioned in the grill above the ash depository; and a cooking rack positioned above the firebox basket.

(9) The firebox basket comprises a support basket and a plurality of ceramic pieces. The support basket defines an internal area and comprises a plurality of concentrically stacked rungs that define a side wall of a charcoal basket, and a grate positioned at a bottom of the plurality of concentrically stacked rungs. The plurality of ceramic pieces is disposed within the support basket, wherein the support basket is configured to support the plurality of ceramic pieces around the internal area of the support basket and wherein at least one of the ceramic pieces of the plurality of ceramic pieces is configured to be removable from the firebox basket.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is an exploded diagram of a grill including one form of a firebox basket.

(2) FIG. 2 is a perspective view of one form a firebox basket for a barbeque grill or smoker.

(3) FIG. 3 is a top view of one form of a firebox basket for a barbeque grill or smoker.

(4) FIG. 4 is a side view of one form of a firebox basket for a barbeque grill or smoker.

(5) FIG. 5 is a perspective view of one form of a firebox basket for a barbeque grill or smoker showing a ceramic plate removed from the support basket.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(6) Embodiments and implementations of the present disclosure provide an improved firebox basket for use in a barbecue grill or smoker. In one form, the firebox basket may be designed for use in any kettle grill. However, it should be appreciated that in other forms, the firebox basket could be modified for use in a kamado-style grill or any other type of grill or smoker.

(7) FIG. 1 is an exploded diagram of one form a grill **100** including a firebox basket. The grill **100** includes a KONTROL TOWER top vent **1**, a lid handle bracket **2**, a grill dome **3**, a lid handle **4**, half moon cooking grates/rack **5**, a heat deflector **6**, a KETTLE SLOROLLER **7**, a plurality of ceramic plates **8**, a support basket **9**, an ash drawer **10**, an ash drawer base **11**, a hinge/lid bracket **12**, a hinge **13**, a hinge bracket **14**, a left-side shelf **15**, a grill base **16**, a right-side shelf **17**, a grill base bottom **18**, legs **19**, a bottom plate **20**, locking swivel casters **21**, and non-locking swivel casters **22**. One form of a firebox basket **23** including the plurality of ceramic plates **8** and the support basket **9** is described below

(8) FIGS. 2-5 illustrate different views of a firebox basket **202** for use in a barbeque grill or smoker such as the grill **100** illustrated in FIG. 1. A firebox basket **202** may comprise a support basket **204** and a plurality of ceramic pieces **206** disposed within the support basket **204**. In some implementations, the support basket **204** is configured to support the plurality of ceramic pieces **206** around an internal area defined by the support basket **204**. In some implementations, the

plurality of ceramic pieces **206** may each be independently removable and replaceable. However, in other implementations, not all of the ceramic pieces **206** may be removable, and in such implementations, at least one ceramic piece may be permanently incorporated into the structure of the firebox basket **202**. The use of the plurality of ceramic pieces **206** in conjunction with the support basket **204** improves temperature stability and heat retention of any kettle grill.

(9) In some implementations, the support basket **204** comprises a plurality of concentrically stacked rungs **208** forming a side wall of the firebox basket **202**. In some implementations, the concentrically stacked rungs **208** may comprise a space in between each adjacent rung. In some implementations, the stacked rungs **208** may each be circular in shape and of sequentially different sizes such that the basket appears tapered. In some implementations, the plurality of concentrically stacked rungs **208** comprises of a metal, such as stainless steel. However, it should be understood that the support basket **204** may have any shape so as to correspond to any desired application.

(10) The firebox basket **202** can further comprise a grate **210** disposed in a bottom portion of the firebox basket **202** that comprises a plurality of bars. The grate **210** can be configured to support fuel, such as charcoal and/or wood, thereon. In some implementations, the grate **210** is positioned to support fuel above an ash depository (item **10** in FIG. 1). For instance, the firebox basket **202** may comprise a plurality of feet **212** configured to support the support basket **204** above the ash depository. In some implementations, the space between the bars can be optimized to improve fuel burning within the firebox basket **202**.

(11) In some implementations, the grate **210** and at least a bottom rung of the plurality of concentrically stacked rungs **208** define a support space configured to receive the plurality of ceramic pieces **206**. In some implementations, the support space is disposed around an outer perimeter of the grate **210**, as shown in FIG. 5.

(12) The plurality of ceramic pieces **206** may be disposed within the support basket **204**. In some implementations, the plurality of ceramic pieces **206** are shaped to be a plurality of ceramic side-wall pieces that are removable from within the support basket **204**. In some implementations, the side-wall ceramic pieces **206** are shaped in a curved trapezoid such that when arranged in an orderly fashion around the interior of the side walls of the support basket **204**, the plurality of ceramic pieces **206** substantially cover an area defined by the interior of the firebox basket **202**.

(13) In some implementations, the ceramic pieces of the plurality of ceramic pieces **206** may be composed of a thick ceramic material. As noted above, in some implementations, each ceramic piece of the plurality of ceramic pieces **206** may be independently removable from within the support basket **204**. This can allow for both retention of heat within the basket in addition to ease of cleaning and replacement of broken ceramic pieces.

(14) When firebox baskets **202**, such as those described above, are used in conjunction with a barbecue grill and smoker, the firebox basket **202** can be placed in a bottom shell of the grill where fuel is typically placed. Accordingly, fuel can be placed within the firebox basket **202**. In some implementations, the firebox basket can further comprise a plurality of handles **214** disposed about a top portion of the support basket **204** such that the firebox basket **202** can be suspended within the grill using one or more of the handles **214**. Further, in some implementations, a cooking rack (item **5** in FIG. 1) can be placed on top of the firebox basket **202** so that food can be cooked or smoked directly over the fuel in the firebox basket **202**. For instance, the cooking rack can be placed directly on top of the plurality of handles **214** of the firebox basket **202**.

(15) Although embodiments and implementations of the present disclosure have been described in detail above, the present disclosure is not limited to these specific embodiments and implementations, and various modifications and changes can be made within the scope of the disclosure. Therefore, it is intended that this disclosure not be limited to the particular embodiments and implementations disclosed, but that the disclosure will include all embodiments and implementations falling within the scope of the appended claims.

Claims

1. A firebox basket configured to use with a grill, comprising: a support basket defining an internal area, the support basket comprising: a plurality of concentrically stacked rungs that define a side wall of the firebox basket; and a grate positioned at a bottom of the plurality of concentrically stacked rungs, the grate comprising a plurality of bars; a plurality of feet configured to support the support basket above an ash depository of the grill; and a plurality of ceramic pieces disposed within the support basket; wherein the support basket is configured to support the plurality of ceramic pieces around the internal area of the support basket; and wherein the positioning of the support basket above the ash depository by the plurality of feet, together with a positioning of the plurality of bars, optimize the burning of fuel that is burning within the firebox basket.
 2. The firebox basket of claim 1, wherein at least one ceramic piece of the plurality of ceramic pieces is configured to be removable from the firebox basket.
 3. The firebox basket of claim 1, wherein at least one ceramic piece of the plurality of ceramic pieces permanently incorporated into the firebox basket.
 4. The firebox basket of claim 1, wherein at least a bottom rung of the plurality of concentrically stacked rungs and the grate define a support space configured to receive the plurality of ceramic pieces.
 5. The firebox basket of claim 4, wherein the support space is disposed around an outer perimeter of the grate.
 6. The firebox basket of claim 1, wherein the plurality of concentrically stacked rungs defines a space between adjacent rungs of the plurality of concentrically stacked rungs.
 7. The firebox basket of claim 1, wherein the rungs of the plurality of concentrically stacked rungs are different sizes.
 8. The firebox basket of claim 1, wherein the rungs of the plurality of concentrically stacked rungs are circular.
 9. The firebox basket of claim 1, wherein the rungs of the plurality of concentrically stacked rungs comprise metal.
 10. The firebox basket of claim 9, wherein the metal is stainless steel.
 11. The firebox basket of claim 1, wherein the ceramic pieces of the plurality of ceramic pieces are shaped as a curved trapezoid.
 12. A grill comprising: an ash depository; a firebox basket positioned in the grill above the ash depository; and a cooking rack positioned above the firebox basket; wherein the firebox basket comprises: a support basket defining an internal area, the support basket comprising: a plurality of concentrically stacked rungs that define a side wall of the firebox basket; and a grate positioned at a bottom of the plurality of concentrically stacked rungs, the grate comprising a plurality of bars; a plurality of ceramic pieces disposed within the support basket; and a plurality of feet configured to support the support basket above the ash depository such that a position of the support basket, together with positioning of the plurality of bar, optimize burning of fuel within the firebox basket; wherein the support basket is configured to support the plurality of ceramic pieces around the internal area of the support basket; and wherein at least one of the ceramic pieces of the plurality of ceramic pieces is configured to be removable from the firebox basket.
 13. The grill of claim 12, wherein at least one ceramic piece of the plurality of ceramic pieces permanently incorporated into the firebox basket.
 14. The grill of claim 12, wherein the rungs of the plurality of concentrically stacked rungs are circular.
 15. The grill of claim 12, wherein the rungs of the plurality of concentrically stacked rungs comprise stainless steel.
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